

Essential Windows and everyday typing shortcuts every beginner should know — these work almost everywhere on a Windows PC.

Windows Basics

Shortcut	What it does
Windows key	Open the Start menu.
Windows + D	Show or hide the desktop.
Windows + E	Open File Explorer.
Windows + L	Lock your computer.
Windows + I	Open Settings.
Alt + Tab	Switch between open windows/apps.
Alt + F4	Close the current window or app.
Ctrl + Shift + Esc	Open Task Manager directly.
Ctrl + Alt + Delete	Open the security/options screen.

Everyday Editing (works almost everywhere)

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + C	Copy the selected item.
Ctrl + X	Cut the selected item.
Ctrl + V	Paste.
Ctrl + Z	Undo the last action.
Ctrl + Y	Redo the last undone action.
Ctrl + A	Select everything.
Ctrl + S	Save the current file.
Ctrl + P	Print the current file.
Ctrl + F	Search / Find within the page or app.

Browser Shortcuts

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + T	Open a new browser tab.
Ctrl + W	Close the current tab.
Ctrl + Shift + T	Reopen the last closed tab.
Ctrl + L or Alt + D	Jump to the address bar.
Ctrl + Tab	Switch to the next open tab.
F5 or Ctrl + R	Refresh the current page.

Taking Screenshots

Shortcut	What it does
PrtScn (Print Screen)	Copy the entire screen to the clipboard.
Windows + Shift + S	Snip a chosen area of the screen (Snipping Tool).
Windows + PrtScn	Save a full screenshot directly to a Screenshots folder.

Tip: you don't need to memorize all of these at once — pin this sheet near your desk and pick up a few shortcuts a week.